RICOTTA, APPLE AND DRIED FRUIT FILLING

INGREDIENTS

348 g	Ricotta
57 g	Smoked ricotta, coarsely grated
64 g	Granny Smith apple, peeled and finely grated
29 g	Dried pear, finely chopped
15 g	Golden raisins, finely chopped
28 g	Montasio cheese, finely grated
1 orange	Orange peel, pith removed and finely chopped
1 lemon	Lemon peel, pith removed and finely chopped
1/4 tsp	Cinnamon, freshly ground
1/2 tsp	Natural cocoa powder
quantity not given	Salt
quantity not given	Black pepper

METHOD

1. Pass the ricotta through a tamis or a fine-mesh strainer into a bowl.
2. Add the smoked ricotta, apple, pear, raisins, Montasio, both citrus peels, the cinnamon and the cocoa. Fold everything together until it is evenly mixed.
3. Season with salt and black pepper. Aim for properly seasoned. Cover it and refrigerate until you are ready to pipe.

NOTES

The mixture sits deliberately between sweet and savory. Apple, dried fruit and cocoa pull one way, the two ricottas, the Montasio and the seasoning pull the other.
Pass the ricotta through a tamis first. That step is what gets the filling smooth enough to pipe through a 1/2-inch tip.
Both peels go in with the pith stripped off, which keeps the citrus aromatic rather than bitter.
Only 1/2 tsp of cocoa goes in. It is a background note against the fruit, not a chocolate flavor.
The mixture is loose and delicate. Pasta filled with it wants a gentle simmer, not a rolling boil.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

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